MIL-T-44064A
30 September 1983
SUPERSEDING
MIL-T-44064
27 December 1982

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

TURKEY, DICED, WITH GRAVY, THERMOSTABILIZED, FOR MEAL, READY-TO-EAT

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers thermostabilized diced turkey with gravy in flexible pouches for use as a component of the Meal, Ready-to-Eat, Individual.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

* 2.1 Government documents. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

N-F-481	-	Flour, Wheat
EE-B-575	-	Bouillon (Soup and Gravy Base)
PP-T-1823	-	Turkey, Boneless, Frozen, Raw or Cooked
JJJ-S-30	-	Salad Oil, Vegetable

MILITARY

MIL-S-43855	-	Salts, Celery, Garlic and Onions
MIL-P-44073	-	Packaging and Thermoprocessing of Foods in Flexible Pouches

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research and Development Laboratories, Natick, MA 01760 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 8940

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STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

MIL-STD-900 - Bacterial Standards for Starches, Flours, Cereals, Alimentary Pastes, Dry Milks, and Sugars Used in the Preparation of Canned Foods for the Armed Forces

(Copies of documents required by manufacturers in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

OTHER GOVERNMENT DOCUMENTS

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

Regulations Governing the Voluntary Grading of Poultry Products and Rabbit Products and U.S. Classes, Standards, and Grades.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Director, Poultry Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

2.2 Other publications. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

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ASSOCIATION OF OFFICIAL ANALYTICAL CHEMISTS

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 1111 North 19th Street, Suite 210, Arlington, VA 22209.)

(Technical society and technical association documents are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.4, 6.1 and 6.3).

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent and insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Turkey. Turkey shall be prepared from chilled or frozen Grade B or better ready-to-cook yearling turkeys or young tom turkeys or a combination of classes. Wing tips, necks, backs, or giblets shall not be used. The turkey meat shall be in excellent condition at the time of use. Time of slaughter to incorporation into the final product shall not exceed 120 days. Alternatively, a turkey roll complying with the requirement for type III, condition B, class 1 of PP-T-1823, and the 120 day requirement, may be used (except that up to 1.0 percent salt may be used). Turkey shipped between plants shall be accompanied by a USDA Poultry Grading Branch Certificate.

3.2.2 Vegetable oil. Vegetable oil shall comply with the requirements of type B - cotton seed oil or corn oil of JJJ-S-30.

3.2.3 Flour. Flour shall comply with the requirements of type III of N-F-481.

3.2.4 Cornstarch. Cornstarch shall be modified waxy maize starch of the type used in canned, heat processed foods. It shall be bland with essentially no cereal or starch taste. It shall be white, odorless and finely pulverized. The starch shall comply with the requirements of MIL-STD-900.

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3.2.5 Chicken base. Chicken flavored soup and gravy base shall comply with the requirements for type II, class I, style A of EE-B-575.

3.2.6 Onion salt. Onion salt shall comply with the requirements for type III of MIL-S-43855.

3.3 Preparation and processing.

* 3.3.1 Meat preparation. The turkey shall be prepared as follows:

a. The feet, metacarpus-phalanges section of the wings, giblets, bones, coarse connective tissue, blood clots, bruises, or discolored meat exceeding 0.3 inch in any dimension shall be excluded from the formulation.

b. The deboned turkey meat shall consist of not less than 50 percent or more than 60 percent white meat with the remaining percentage dark meat, and shall be water cooked, roasted, or steamed. Save broth or drippings for use in gravy preparation. Cooking in casing and dicing of the cooked turkey is permissible, but grinding, flaking and chopping are not acceptable.

c. The turkey meat shall be diced no greater than 3/4-inch in the largest dimension and not less than 1/2-inch in the shortest dimension.

d. Precooked, frozen turkey dices of the same dimensions may be purchased from a commercial deboning operation and shall comply with the requirements of 3.2.1 and the requirements of 3.3.1, items a and c.

* 3.3.1.1 Handling and storage of cooked turkey. Cooked turkey not prepared into the finished product on the same day as cooking shall be handled and stored in accordance with the following requirements.

a. Holding cooked turkey in the frozen state for not more than 14 days is permitted provided that the turkey is placed in a freezer at 0°F or lower within 4 hours after cooking and frozen to 0°F within 8 hours after placement in the freezer.

b. Holding cooked turkey in the chilled or thawed state for not more than 72 hours prior to final preparation is permitted provided that the temperature of turkey does not exceed 40°F at any time. There shall be no evidence of refreezing.

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3.3.2 Gravy preparation. The gravy shall be prepared from the following ingredients:

Ingredient	Percent by weight
Water and broth 1/	84.00
Chicken base	5.00
Cornstarch	3.50
Wheat flour	3.50
Vegetable oil	3.00
Onion salt	1.00

1/ Broth is not required when precooked turkey pieces in accordance with 3.3.1 d are used.

The gravy shall be prepared as follows:

a. All dry ingredients shall be premixed.

b. The water, broth and chicken base shall be mixed and dry ingredients added with rapid agitation.

c. The mixture shall be heated to 140°F.

d. The vegetable oil shall be added and the mixture heated to 180°F with agitation and held a minimum of 5 minutes at this temperature.

e. The volume of the final mixture shall be adjusted to compensate for evaporation loss during heating and holding.

f. If a hot fill system is not to be used, the prepared gravy mixture shall be cooled immediately and held not more than 4 hours at a temperature not to exceed 50°F prior to filling pouches.

* 3.3.3 Pouch filling and processing. The product shall be filled and processed such as to conform to the following requirements.

a. Filling, sealing and thermoprocessing shall conform to the class 1 requirements of MIL-P-44073.

b. A hot fill system is permitted if compatible with the filling and sealing method used.

c. If a hot fill system is not used, the turkey and gravy temperatures at time of filling shall not exceed 45°F.

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d. Average net weight shall be 5.0 ounces minimum.

e. No individual pouch shall contain less than 4.8 ounces of product.

f. The average drained weight of turkey dices shall be 2.5 ounces minimum.

g. No individual pouch shall contain less than 2.0 ounces of drained turkey dices.

h. The filled and sealed pouch shall be thermoprocessed until a sterilization value (F_o) of not less than 6 has been achieved.

* 3.4 Finished product. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements:

a. There shall be no foreign material such as, but not limited to glass, paint, metal, dirt, insects, insect parts, hair, wood, or paper.

b. There shall be no foreign odor or flavor such as, but not limited to burnt, scorched, stale, sour, rancid, musty, or moldy.

c. There shall be no foreign color such as, but not limited to black, purple, or green.

d. There shall be no bone pieces measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.

e. There shall be no cartilage or section of tendons or ligaments more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.

f. There shall be no pieces of skin, blood clot, bruised, or discolored meat exceeding 0.3 inch in any dimension.

g. Turkey dice size shall not exceed 3/4 inch in the longest dimension and not less than 1/2 inch in the shortest dimension.

h. Gravy shall be present.

i. Texture of turkey dices shall not be dry, rubbery, or mushy.

j. Gravy shall not be excessively thick, thin or lumpy.

k. At least 75 percent of turkey dices shall be discernable as distinct dices.

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l. The fat content shall not exceed 8 percent.

m. The salt content shall not exceed 1.25 percent.

3.4.1 Palatability. The product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.5 Plant qualification. The poultry component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture.

3.6 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this document. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and acceptance service. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of acceptance service necessary to assure compliance with the requirements of this document. The cost of grading and acceptance services performed by the USDA involving inspection, official documentation, and related services shall be borne by the contractor.

4.3 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

* 4.4 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this document and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this document or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

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4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.5.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

4.5.1.1 Turkey examination. Examination of turkey shall be made to determine conformance to the requirements of 3.2 and 3.2.1. Records of temperature and time shall be maintained. Nonconformance to one or more condition requirements or to temperature and storage requirements reflected by actual examination or records, shall be cause for rejection of the involved quantity of product or the finished product made therefrom, as applicable.

4.5.1.2 Other ingredient examination. Conformance of ingredients to identity and condition requirements shall be determined by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade certificates, invoices, certificates of analysis or other valid documents. In addition, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically as necessary to determine conformance to the condition requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient lot or of any involved product.

4.5.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to preparation and processing requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation or other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.5.3 Filled and sealed pouch inspection. Inspection of filled and sealed pouches shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-P-44073.

4.5.4 Net weight inspection. The net weight of the filled and sealed pouches shall be determined by weighing each sample unit on a suitable scale tared with a representative empty pouch. Any individual net weight of less than 4.8 ounces shall be scored as a minor defect. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed pouch. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5. Results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce. In addition, the lot shall be rejected if the sample average net weight is less than 5.0 ounces.

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* 4.5.5 Product inspection. The filled and sealed pouches shall be held for a minimum of 72 hours at room temperature (65° to 75°F) after completion of the thermoprocessing operation. The pouches shall be heated in boiling water, opened, and inspected for the defects indicated in table I. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be the contents of one pouch. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.5 for major defects and 6.5 for minor defects.

TABLE I. Product inspection 1/ 2/

Category		Defect
Major B	Minor	
151		Gravy missing.
152		Presence of bone that measures more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.
153		Presence of cartilage or section of tendon or ligament that measures more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.
154		Presence of skin, blood clots, bruised or discolored meat that measures more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.
	201	Turkey pieces measuring more than 3/4 inch in longest dimension and less than 1/2 inch in shortest dimension.
155		Drained weight of turkey dices in a pouch is less than 2.0 ounces. 3/ 4/
156		Texture of turkey dices dry, rubbery, or mushy.
157		Dices not discernible (less than 75 percent distinct dices).
158		Color not characteristic of product (materially darkened, scorched, or oxidized).
159		Gravy excessively thick, thin or lumpy.

1/ Presence of any foreign material (e.g. glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal, etc.), foreign odor or flavor (e.g. burnt, scorched, stale, sour, rancid, musty, moldy, etc.), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (To be determined by a Meat and Poultry Inspection Operations employee.)

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2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability or overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (This comparison shall be performed only when deemed necessary by an AMS agent.)

3/ To determine drained weight, the pouch contents shall be emptied into a flat bottom container. Approximately three times the pouch volume of 180° to 212°F water shall be added to the container so as to cover the contents. The contents and water shall be agitated such as to liquify rendered fat and to separate the turkey pieces without breaking the turkey pieces. The contents shall then be poured into a U.S. Standard 1/4 inch sieve in a manner that will distribute the product over the sieve. Sieve area shall be such that the distributed product does not completely cover all the openings of the sieve. The sieve shall be tilted slightly and allowed to drain for 2 minutes before determining the drained weight by subtracting the sieve tare weight from the gross weight. The drained weight shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce.

4/ If the sample average drained weight is less than 2.5 ounces, the lot shall be rejected.

4.5.6 Product testing. The product shall be tested for fat content as specified in 4.5.6.1 and for salt content as specified in 4.5.6.2. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be the contents of one filled and sealed pouch. The sample size shall be the number of sample units indicated by inspection level S-2. Any test result not conforming to the applicable fat or salt content requirement specified in 3.4 shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

* 4.5.6.1 Fat content testing. The product shall be tested for fat content in accordance with the Fosslet method or the Crude Fat or Ether Extract method (using petroleum ether) in the Meat and Meat Products chapter of the Official Methods of the Analysis of the Association of Analytical Chemists. The results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent.

4.5.6.2 Salt content testing. The product shall be tested for salt content in accordance with the Meat section in the Meat and Meat Products chapter of the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Analytical Chemists. The results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent.

4.5.7 Packaging inspection. Inspection of packaging shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-P-44073.

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5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be in accordance with the applicable requirements of MIL-P-44073.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.4 and 6.3).
c. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.4.1 and 6.3).

6.2 Award of contract. Award of contract for product specified in this document will be limited to plants known to maintain the required sanitation conditions (see 3.5).

6.3 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of DAR 7-104.55. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.4 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this document are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8940-0435

Review activities:

Army - MD, TS
Navy - MC, MS
DP - SS

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-T-44064A	Turkey, Diced, With Gravy, Thermostabilized, For Meal, Ready-To-Eat

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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